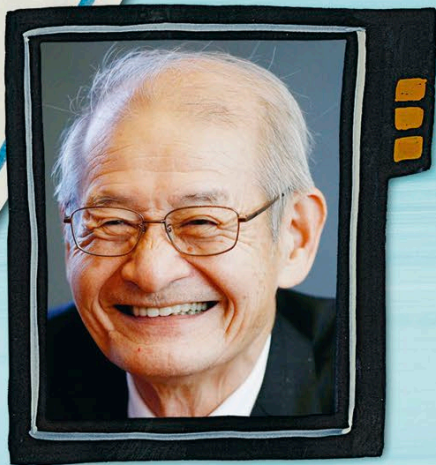




AKIRA YOSHINO

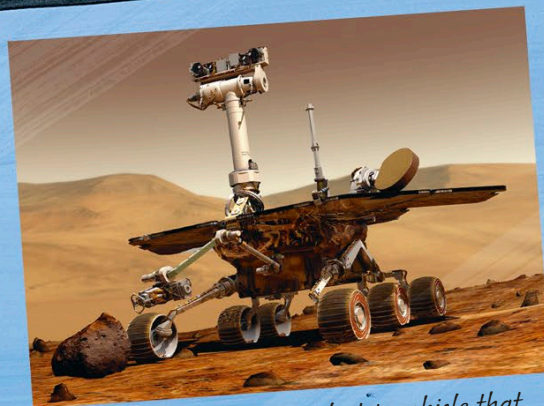
Japanese chemist
1948–present

In the 1970s, scientists figured out how to make powerful computer chips much smaller—so small they could be put into all kinds of new and exciting handheld devices. The trouble was, the rechargeable batteries powering the machines were still far too big and bulky, and they didn't last very long either. Akira Yoshino was tasked with solving this problem.

Most inventors begin by looking at older designs and improving them. However, Akira decided to try something completely different. He helped to create the modern lithium-ion battery, which was smaller, lighter, and easier to recharge than the competition.

Martian motor

Electric cars are becoming more popular as people try to use less fossil fuel. By 2040, it is predicted that more than 50 million electric vehicles will be zooming around the world's roads—with a handful on other planets, too!



Opportunity was an electric vehicle that drove around Mars for more than 10 years.